

MONASTERY



ONASTERY IS A MONSTER SUPPLEMENT FOR 5E THAT PRESENTS MONASTIC COMMUNITIES NOT AS ISOLATED background locations but as structured social and spiritual institutions. Rather than treating monasteries as places that simply provide healing and rest, this supplement introduces a full hierarchy of disciplined residents who maintain, defend, and govern sacred grounds.

The intent of this product is to give GMs a ready-made roster of low-CR NPCs appropriate for sanctuary locations. Monasteries appear frequently in campaigns as places of refuge, learning, diplomacy, or pilgrimage, yet their inhabitants are rarely defined beyond generic monks or priests. This ladder provides a clear structure of novices, laborers, scholars, healers, defenders, and leadership, allowing monasteries to feel alive and internally organized.

Encounters involving monasteries emphasize restraint, discipline, and sanctuary rather than open warfare. Most residents avoid violence unless sacred ground or innocent lives are threatened. When conflict does occur, defenders act to contain, disarm, and remove intruders rather than pursue them. A monastery encounter should feel calm, controlled, and morally grounded rather than chaotic.

Cultural doctrine, deity, and regional traditions are intentionally left undefined. Some monasteries may serve specific gods, others philosophical orders, and others still ancient traditions predating modern faiths. Use these stat blocks as adaptable tools to populate temples, isolated mountain cloisters, urban abbeys, or wandering monastic missions.

MONASTERY ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Monastery Novice	0	Young initiate performing chores, copying texts, and learning the discipline required for monastic life.
Monastery Lay Brother	1/8	Non-ordained worker responsible for agriculture, supplies, and daily operations within the monastery.
Monastery Archivist	1/4	Keeper of manuscripts and historical records who maintains the monastery's knowledge and doctrine.
Monastery Healer	1	Devoted caretaker trained in restorative medicine and spiritual care for pilgrims and residents.
Monastery Martial Devotee	2	Disciplined defender trained to protect sacred ground and remove threats with controlled force.
Monastery Abbot	3	Spiritual leader and administrator who governs the monastery and guides its doctrine and purpose.



MONASTERY HEALER

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 11

Hit Points 27 (6d8)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)

Skills Insight +4, Medicine(x) +6, Religion +2

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common plus one other

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Restorative Care. When the healer uses an action to stabilize a creature at 0 hit points, that creature regains 1 hit point. This only applies once.

Herbal Remedies. The healer carries prepared herbs and salves. As an action, the healer can restore 5 (1d8 + 1) hit points to a creature within 5 feet. The healer can use this trait three times, regaining all uses after a long rest.

ACTIONS:

Staff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

- The healer prioritizes aiding wounded allies or innocents rather than fighting.
- If violence erupts in the monastery, the healer moves between the injured and attempts to stabilize them.
- The healer may refuse aid to those who desecrate sacred ground or harm the monastery's residents.



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